The Marvel Way

Exploratory Data Analysis

Problem Statement

Arguably the most iconic comic book publisher behind some the most influential superheroes and villains, *Marvel*, originally *Timely Comics* founded in 1939 by publisher Martin Goodman, has paved the way for your favorite comic characters such as *Spiderman, The Hulk, the X-Men* and so many more. Legendary names such as comic book writer and editor Stan Lee, artists Jack Kirby and Todd McFarlane along with many others have given life and story to these famous characters through their creative fueled collaborations. With a combination of their dynamic storylines and energetic visuals, *Marvel* has cemented itself as one of the most recognizable comic brands both on page and cinema.

The *Marvel Comics* dataset is intended to give insight into which writer/s and penciler/s have collaborated the most, how many comic issues they have produced together and the duration of these comic issues. Duration of a comic series is measured by how the long the comic was active, from its start year to its end year, not how long each writer/penciler collaborated. For example, *The Incredible Hulk* series began in 1962 by writer Stan Lee and penciler/writer Jack Kirby and ran until 1999, spanning a total of 37 years. *The Incredible Hulk* is considered one of the most prolific series in *Marvel's* history. During this time artist Sal Buscema and Bill Mantlo also stamped their names on this incredible series during the early to mid 1980s.

Not only are there dynamic collaborations within this dataset, but there are also solo creators who both wrote and penciled their comics. One creator that stands out based on the dataset is Steve Ditko and his work on *The Amazing Spider-Man Annual*. This series began in 1964 and ended fairly recently in 2018, a total of 54 years. Once again, the 54 years represents how long the comic ran, not how long the creator worked on the series. During this time frame the dataset also shows that Fred Hembeck also worked on this series during the late 1980s, however his work is not considered a part of the main story lines within *The Amazing Spider-Man* of this time period.

By analyzing both the formidable alliances and solo work of writers and pencilers, entertainment executives can make more informed decisions about which writers and pencilers have created the most successful comic books based on how many issues they have collaborated on, the duration of the series and how many times they have collaborated.

Business Impact

The analysis of the *Marvel Comics* dataset could help entertainment executives:

- Identify which writer and penciler collaborations form the most elite team based on number of comic issues published together and the duration of each comic series.
- Gain insight to which writers/pencilers have a better chance for marketability.
- Which solo writer/pencilers have the most issue count and how long the issues they worked on lasted.

Overall, the analysis of the Marvel Comics Dataset is an attempt to give entertainment executives better insight to which writer/penciler collaborations will generate the most success from comic books to cinema. From a business perspective, marketability and revenue are the most important factors within comic and entertainment industries.

General Dataset Information

File Name:	Marvel Comics.csv
Description:	The dataset contains info on all the comic books ever released in the Marvel Universe.
Dataset Details:	34993 Rows and 12 Columns
Size:	13.62MB
Source:	Kaggle

Target Features

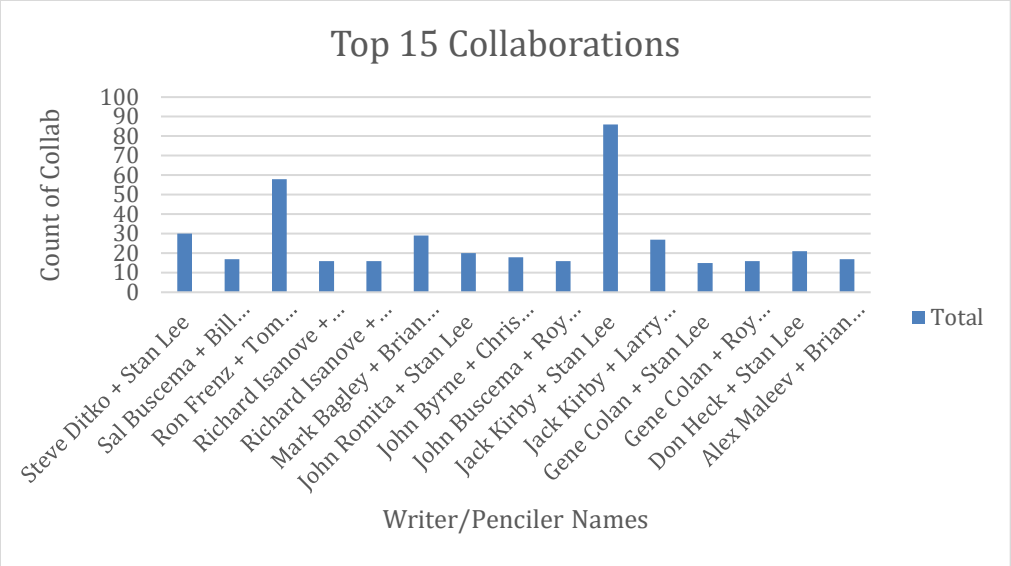
The columns that will be used to simplify and analyze the problem statement are:

- issue title: Name of comic series
- writer/penciler 1-4: Gives the names of writer/pencilers
- collab name, collab count, issue title, start/end year, total years
- solo name, solo count, issue title, start/end year, total years
- Collaboration
- Collab issue count/solo issue count

List of Analysis

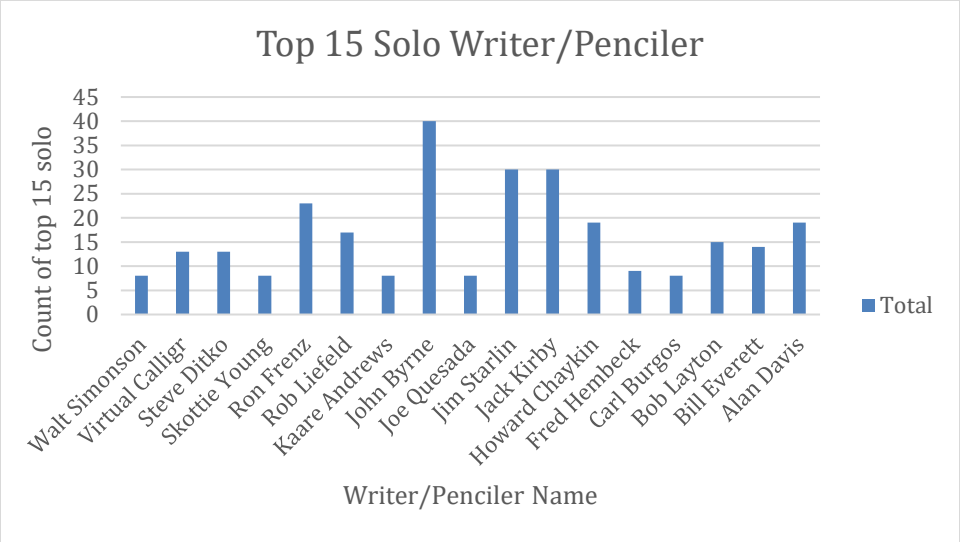
1- Collaboration Analysis

Marvel legends Jack Kirby and Stan Lee have the most overall collaborations according to the dataset at 86 total collaborations. This is based on an excel pivot table and bar chart titled Top 15 Collaborations.



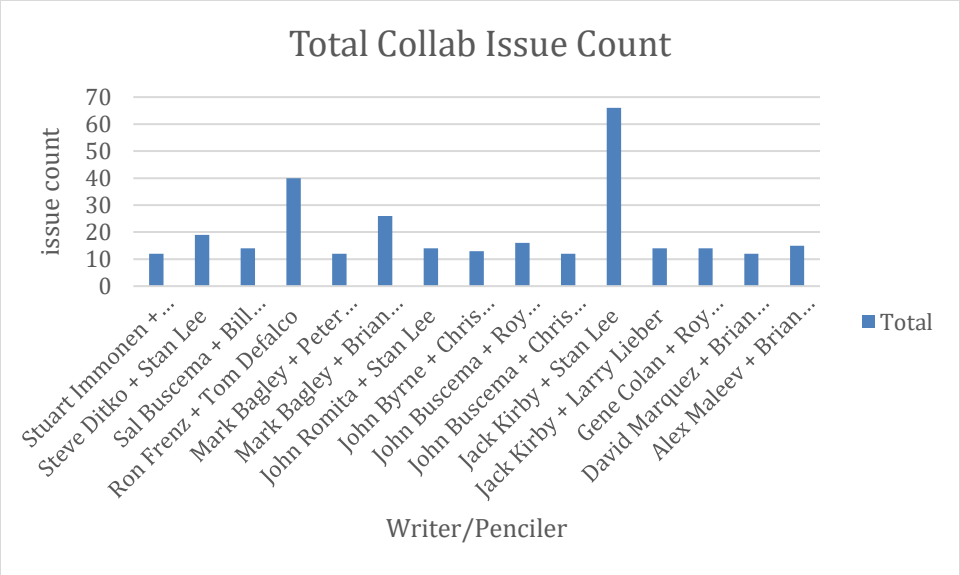
2- Top 15 Solo writer/penciler

John Byrne, Jim Starlin and Jack Kirby have all both written and penciled their comic series the most.



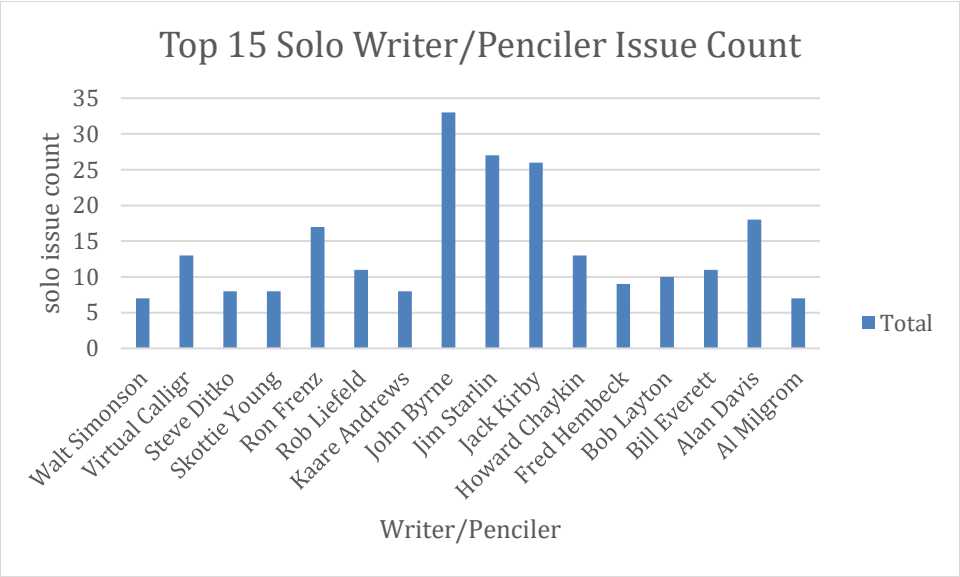
3- Total Collab Issue Count (top 15)

Jack Kirby and Stan Lee also are number one when it comes to the count of issues they have collaborated on, being 66 comic issues. Ron Frenz and Tom Defalco have the second most issues collaborated on. This is also demonstrated utilizing a pivot table and bar chart.



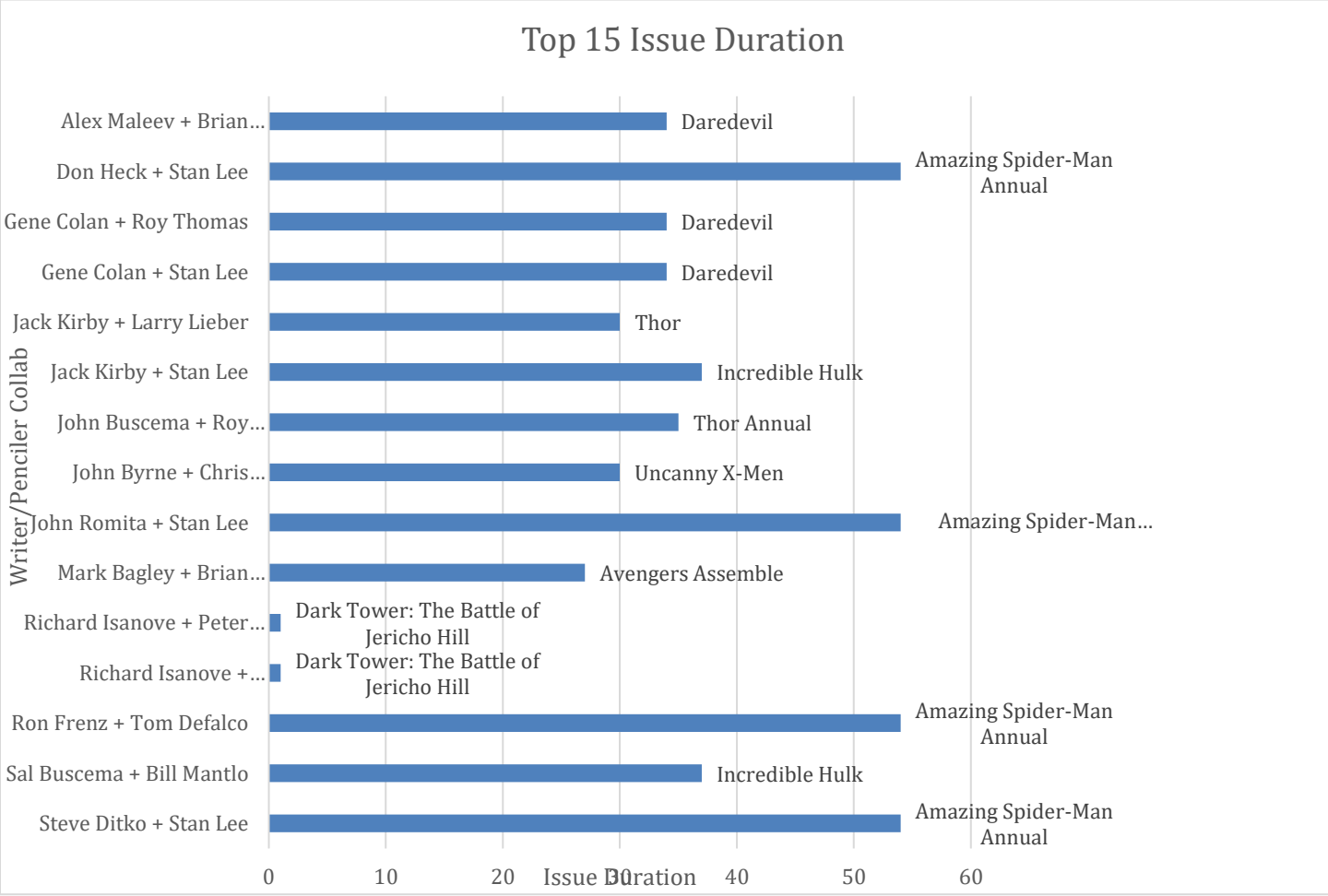
4- Top 15 Solo Writer/Penciler Issue Count

John Byrne, Jim Starlin and Jack Kirby lead the way when it comes to the number of issues they have both written and penciled. John Byrne with 33 issues total, Jim Starlin with 27 solo issues and Jack Kirby with 26.



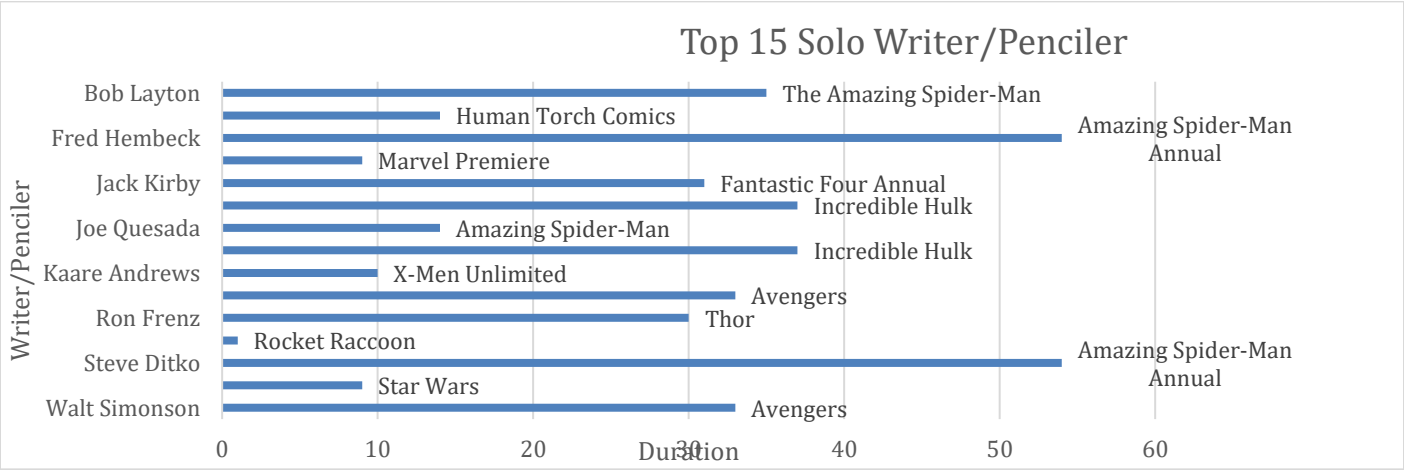
5- Top 15 Issue Collab Duration

The *Amazing Spider-Man* and *Incredible Hulk* have the longest duration, with the *Amazing Spider-Man* spanning 54 years and the *Incedible Hulk* spanning 37 years.



6- Top 15 Solo Issue Duration

Once again the *Amazing Spider-Man* and *Incredible Hulk* have the longest duration, however this indicates the writer/pencilers solo work on the issues.



Conclusion

It is no surprise that names such as Stan Lee, Jack Kirby, John Byrne, Steve Ditko and comic series such as the *Amazing Spider-Man Annual* and *Incredible Hulk* stand out, based on the dataset as these are some of the most iconic names and characters in *Marvel's* history. Although some of these real-life superheroes of *Marvel* have gone on, entertainment executives can use similar datasets to determine modern day prolific writer/penciler collaborations, not just for *Marvel,* but for any publishing company that produces comics, from traditional comics to Manga and Anime.